

Three Everesters of Arunachal Pradesh being felicitated by the author: Tapi Mra (top), Tine Mena (left) and Anshu Jansempa (right).

The first and only Everester from our state till recently was Tapi Mra. His was a one-man expedition to Mount Everest. During his daring bid in the summer of 2009, I received a desperate call from him from the base camp for financial assistance of $1000 or his sherpa would desert him. I assured him of this help and as a result he was able to go ahead with his mission. He climbed the Everest taking only 53 hours from the base camp to the summit. This is the fifth-fastest time in the world. On 1 April 2011, I had the pleasure of flagging off the first women's expedition to Mount Everest by two Arunachalee women, Anshu Jansempa and Tine Mena, who had earlier climbed Mount Nepal Peak (7169 metres). It is a matter of great pride for all of us in Arunachal that both the women climbed the Everest and established a record for being the first women from the northeast to do so. Tine Mena created history on 9 May 2011 and Anshu Jansempa, a mother of two, summited three days later.